

U.S. HISTORY HACK™

Teacher Graphic Organizer Toolkit

Unit 9 — The Civil Rights Movement (1954–1975) • Reproducible

WHY THIS TOOLKIT

Knowing WHICH organizer to use, and WHEN, is half the battle. This toolkit tells you — with a brief why for each — then gives you reproducible blanks (Part 1) and per-standard Cornell support backs (Part 2). Tennessee connections are highlighted throughout; the local-to-national move is a HistoryHack signature and a point of difference for our classrooms.

Which Organizer, When — Quick Guide

Scan the left column for what the activity asks students to do; reach for the organizer on the right. Every organizer in Part 1 also carries its own “when to use · why it works” note.

When the task asks students to...	Reach for...	Why it works
compare / contrast TWO things	Venn (2) or T-Chart	Marzano's highest-yield strategy; the overlap names shared traits
compare 3+ things on set criteria	Compare & Contrast Matrix	systematic; lowers cognitive load
explain causes / effects	Cause & Effect	makes causal chains visible (SSP.05)
put events in order / show change	Timeline / Sequence	builds chronological reasoning (SSP.05)
brainstorm or connect ideas	Concept Web	activates prior knowledge; shows relationships
summarize a text or source	Main Idea & Details	separates the central idea from support
activate prior knowledge & track learning	KWL	metacognition; frames inquiry
learn a key term deeply	Frayer	deep vocabulary processing
analyze a primary source	HIPPO / OPTIC	disciplinary sourcing (SSP.01–02)
make and defend a claim	CER	claim + evidence + reasoning (SSP.04)
weigh two sides / a decision	T-Chart or Problem–Solution	structures evaluation
capture the basics of an event	5 Ws	ensures full coverage
connect a national event to Tennessee	★ Tennessee Connection	our signature local-to-national move

Reproducible — you may copy these pages for classroom use.

Part 1 — Reusable Blank Organizers (all subjects, all units)

Content-agnostic blanks. Print as many as you need; use across any standard or subject.

Task says “compare,” “contrast,” “how are they alike/different?” for TWO things. Marzano’s #1 strategy (identifying similarities & differences). The shared column forces students to name what overlaps, not just list traits.

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one

factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Venn (3) / Triple T-Chart — Compare THREE

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Comparing three people, groups, or ideas. Use the columns for each item and note shared traits in your notes.

Item A	Item B	Item C
Trait / criterion 1		
Trait / criterion 2		
Trait / criterion 3		
Trait / criterion 4		

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

T-Chart — Two Sides / Pros & Cons / Before-After

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Two categories to sort or weigh: benefits vs costs, pros vs cons, before vs after, cause vs effect. Fast, low-floor entry point for comparison.

[illegible]

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Compare & Contrast Matrix — Items × Criteria

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Comparing several items across the SAME set of criteria. Reduces cognitive load by making the comparison systematic.

Criterion	Item 1	Item 2	Item 3

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Cause & Effect — Causal Chains

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Task asks “what caused...?”, “what were the effects/consequences of...?” Makes causal reasoning visible (builds SSP.05).

Cause	→	Effect
	→	
	→	
	→	
	→	

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Ordering events or tracing change over time. Builds chronological reasoning (SSP.05).

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

Start of a standard: what students Know / Want to know; end: what they Learned. Builds metacognition and frames inquiry.

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

5 Ws — Cover the Basics of an Event

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS Making sure students capture who/what/when/where/why of an event before analysis.	
Question	Answer
Who?	
What?	
When?	
Where?	
Why?	
MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS) Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first. Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?” Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice). Sentence frame: “ _____ because _____, which shows _____.”	

Framer Model — Deep Vocabulary

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Learning a key term deeply (definition, characteristics, examples, non-examples).

Definition (own words)	Characteristics

Examples	Non-examples

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

CER — Build an Argument

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS

Any “make a claim / defend / argue” task. Claim + two pieces of evidence + reasoning (builds SSP.04).

Part	Write here
Claim	
Evidence (two specifics)	
Reasoning	

MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)

Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.

Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”

Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).

Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”

HIPPO — Analyze a Primary Source

WHEN TO USE • WHY IT WORKS	
Analyzing a photo, cartoon, map, or document (builds SSP.01–SSP.02). Pair with OPTIC for visuals.	
H-I-P-P-O	Prompt / notes
H — Historical context	
I — Intended audience	
P — Purpose	
P — Point of view	
O — Outside connection	
MAKE IT WORK FOR EVERY STUDENT (UDL • MTSS)	
Scaffold — offer a sentence starter or a small word bank, or let students complete part of the organizer with a partner first.	
Extend — push higher-DOK: “Which side has the stronger case, and why?” or “What would change if one factor were different?”	
Show it your way — students may write, say it aloud, draw/label, or build it (UDL response choice).	
Sentence frame: “_____ because _____, which shows _____.”	

Part 2 — Cornell Support Backs (per standard, reproducible)

Guided and Light scaffolds for each standard's Cornell notes — moved here from the student workbook so you copy them only as needed (MTSS). Fade Guided → Light → independent as evidence grows.

US.78 — Brown v. Board of Education: Cornell Support Backs

Reproducible — scaffolds ONLY the Cornell notes for this standard. Copy for students who need them; fade as evidence grows. Not a track, not a separate grade.

Guided Support

Key vocabulary	What it means
Brown v. Board of Education	The landmark 1954 Supreme Court decision that declared state laws establishing separate public schools for Black and white students unconstitutional, overturning Plessy v. Ferguson and ending legal school segregation.
Thurgood Marshall	Chief counsel for the NAACP Legal Defense Fund who argued Brown v. Board of Education before the Supreme Court and later became the first African American Supreme Court Justice in 1967.
Resistance	Southern states launched "massive resistance" campaign to defy ruling.

Break it into steps: 1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of brown v. board of education was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of brown v. board of education was Brown v. Board of Education: The landmark 1954 Supreme Court decision that declared state laws establishing separate public schools for Black and white students unconstitutional, overturning Plessy v. Ferguson and ending legal school segregation.

Step	Rehearse it here, then transfer to the Cornell front
Name it	
Evidence	
Explain	
Headline	

Light Support

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — "This term means ..."
Brown v. Board of Education	
Thurgood Marshall	

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Resistance	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below or in your front notes:

- What is the main idea of the “Historical Context Leading to Brown v. Board” section, and what evidence supports it?
- What is the main idea of the “Key Details of the Court Case and Decision” section, and what evidence supports it?
- What is the main idea of the “Impact on Desegregation” section, and what evidence supports it?
- Whose perspective benefits in this passage, and whose is harmed or left out?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?
Circle the Cornell cue you still need help with, and tell your teacher.

US.79 — Civil Rights Advocates and Opponents: Cornell Support Backs

Reproducible — scaffolds ONLY the Cornell notes for this standard. Copy for students who need them; fade as evidence grows. Not a track, not a separate grade.

Guided Support

Key vocabulary	What it means
Little Rock Nine	The nine African American students who integrated Central High School in Little Rock, Arkansas in 1957, facing violent mobs and requiring federal troops protection ordered by President Eisenhower.
Thurgood Marshall	Chief counsel for the NAACP Legal Defense Fund who argued Brown v. Board of Education before the Supreme Court and later became the first African American Supreme Court Justice in 1967.
Rosa Parks	The "Mother of the Civil Rights Movement" who refused to give up her bus seat to a white passenger in Montgomery, Alabama in 1955, sparking the Montgomery Bus Boycott.

Break it into steps: 1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of civil rights advocates and opponents was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of civil rights advocates and opponents was Little Rock Nine: The nine African American students who integrated Central High School in Little Rock, Arkansas in 1957, facing violent mobs and requiring federal troops protection ordered by President Eisenhower.

Step	Rehearse it here, then transfer to the Cornell front
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

Light Support

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — "This term means ..."
Little Rock Nine	_____ _____
Thurgood Marshall	_____ _____

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Rosa Parks	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below or in your front notes:

- What is the main idea of the “Civil Rights Advocates” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - What is the main idea of the “Civil Rights Opponents” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - What is the main idea of the “Comparing Approaches” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - Whose perspective benefits in this passage, and whose is harmed or left out?
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WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?
Circle the Cornell cue you still need help with, and tell your teacher.

US.80 — Significant Civil Rights Events: Cornell Support Backs

Reproducible — scaffolds ONLY the Cornell notes for this standard. Copy for students who need them; fade as evidence grows. Not a track, not a separate grade.

Guided Support

Key vocabulary	What it means
Little Rock Nine	The nine African American students who integrated Central High School in Little Rock, Arkansas in 1957, facing violent mobs and requiring federal troops protection ordered by President Eisenhower.
Rosa Parks	The "Mother of the Civil Rights Movement" who refused to give up her bus seat to a white passenger in Montgomery, Alabama in 1955, sparking the Montgomery Bus Boycott.
Bull Connor	Birmingham, Alabama's Commissioner of Public Safety who violently opposed civil rights protesters in 1963, using police dogs and fire hoses against peaceful demonstrators, including children.

Break it into steps: 1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of significant civil rights events was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of significant civil rights events was Little Rock Nine: The nine African American students who integrated Central High School in Little Rock, Arkansas in 1957, facing violent mobs and requiring federal troops protection ordered by President Eisenhower.

Step	Rehearse it here, then transfer to the Cornell front
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____ _____
Explain	_____ _____ _____
Headline	_____ _____ _____

Light Support

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — "This term means ..."
Little Rock Nine	_____ _____
Rosa Parks	_____ _____

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Bull Connor	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below or in your front notes:

- What is the main idea of the “Early Movement Victories” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - What is the main idea of the “Tennessee's Role in the Movement” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - What is the main idea of the “Confrontations That Changed America” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - Whose perspective benefits in this passage, and whose is harmed or left out?
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WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?
Circle the Cornell cue you still need help with, and tell your teacher.

US.81 — Civil and Voting Rights Legislation: Cornell Support Backs

Reproducible — scaffolds ONLY the Cornell notes for this standard. Copy for students who need them; fade as evidence grows. Not a track, not a separate grade.

Guided Support

Key vocabulary	What it means
Civil Rights Act of 1964	Landmark federal legislation that outlawed discrimination based on race, color, religion, sex, or national origin, ending segregation in public accommodations and employment.
Voting Rights Act of 1965	Federal legislation that outlawed discriminatory voting practices (literacy tests, poll taxes) used to disenfranchise African Americans, dramatically increasing Black voter registration in the South.
Civil Rights Act of 1968 (Fair Housing Act)	Federal law that prohibited discrimination in the sale, rental, and financing of housing based on race, religion, national origin, or sex, addressing residential segregation.

Break it into steps: 1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame	
One key cause/effect of civil and voting rights legislation was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.	
Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)	
A key idea of civil and voting rights legislation was Civil Rights Act of 1964: Landmark federal legislation that outlawed discrimination based on race, color, religion, sex, or national origin, ending segregation in public accommodations and employment.	
Step	Rehearse it here, then transfer to the Cornell front
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

Light Support

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Civil Rights Act of 1964	_____ _____
Voting Rights Act of 1965	_____ _____

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
Civil Rights Act of 1968 (Fair Housing Act)	

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below or in your front notes:

- What is the main idea of the “Civil Rights Act of 1964” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - What is the main idea of the “Voting Rights Act of 1965” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - What is the main idea of the “Civil Rights Act of 1968 (Fair Housing Act)” section, and what evidence supports it?
 - Whose perspective benefits in this passage, and whose is harmed or left out?
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WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?
Circle the Cornell cue you still need help with, and tell your teacher.

US.82 — American Indian, Chicano & Feminist Movements: Cornell Support Backs

Reproducible — scaffolds ONLY the Cornell notes for this standard. Copy for students who need them; fade as evidence grows. Not a track, not a separate grade.

Guided Support

Key vocabulary	What it means
American Indian Movement (AIM)	Civil rights organization founded in 1968 to address issues of poverty, police brutality, and treaty rights affecting Native Americans, using tactics inspired by the Black civil rights movement.
Chicano Movement	Mexican American civil rights movement of the 1960s-70s that fought for labor rights, education reform, political representation, and cultural pride, led by figures like Cesar Chavez.
Tactics	Boycotts, strikes, marches inspired by civil rights movement.

Break it into steps: 1) Name one cause or effect. 2) Give one piece of evidence. 3) Write one sentence explaining the link.

Sentence frame

One key cause/effect of american indian, chicano & feminist movements was _____, shown by _____, which mattered because _____.

Modeled example (one worked note — yours will differ)

A key idea of american indian, chicano & feminist movements was American Indian Movement (AIM): Civil rights organization founded in 1968 to address issues of poverty, police brutality, and treaty rights affecting Native Americans, using tactics inspired by the Black civil rights movement.

Step	Rehearse it here, then transfer to the Cornell front
Name it	_____ _____
Evidence	_____ _____
Explain	_____ _____
Headline	_____ _____

Light Support

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”
American Indian Movement (AIM)	_____ _____
Chicano Movement	_____ _____
Tactics	_____

Key vocabulary	Finish the idea — “This term means ...”

Guiding questions — answer on the lines below or in your front notes:

- What is the main idea of the “American Indian Movement (AIM)” section, and what evidence supports it?
- What is the main idea of the “Chicano Movement” section, and what evidence supports it?
- What is the main idea of the “Feminist Movement” section, and what evidence supports it?
- Whose perspective benefits in this passage, and whose is harmed or left out?

WHICH CUE STILL NEEDS WORK?
Circle the Cornell cue you still need help with, and tell your teacher.